

Prathamesh Khachane

Computer
Engineering

Company: BlackRock

Job Profile: Aladdin Data

Offer Type: Internship

Internship Stipend: 50k

CTC: 18 LPA (Performance based PPO)

Location: Mumbai /Gurugram (Not Specified)

Process Date: 28th August

Placement Process:

The process consisted of 3 rounds 1 Test and 2 technical rounds. The Entire process including interviews was **online**.

1. Technical and Aptitude Test

The round had a mix of technical and aptitude questions, with a total duration of about 90 minutes. It was a proctored test and divided into three sections: Aptitude, DSA, and SQL. All the questions were MCQ-based, so no actual coding was required.

For the aptitude part, the questions were pretty standard—quant, reasoning, and problem-solving type. Practicing from Indiabix is more than enough. I'd suggest taking timed mock tests, because I personally lost a few easy marks just due to time running out :(

The DSA section had MCQs on topics like BSTs, AVL Trees, Merge Sort, time complexities, and guess-the-output questions. Nothing too unexpected, but you need your basics really clear. GeeksforGeeks (GFG) is the best prep source here.

Finally, the SQL section was entirely Oracle SQL based. Lots of questions on joins, subqueries, aggregate functions, etc. If you're comfortable with writing and analyzing queries, you'll be fine

Overall, it was a balanced test—no coding, just solid concepts and quick thinking.

2. Technical Interview I [40 - 50 mins]

here were two interviewers, and the interview began with a quick introduction where I had to talk about myself and my general hobbies. After that, they asked me about the programming languages I was comfortable with, and I said Python. From there, the discussion moved to OOPs concepts in Python. They asked me to share my screen and write a simple Car class with a few objects. Then they followed it up with questions on types of constructors and some magic methods I had used. They specifically asked about the use of `__new__` and `__call__` methods.

Next, I got a string parsing question where I had to convert data into a list of dictionaries. The problem was straightforward, and I felt communication skills played a big role in explaining my thought process clearly.

They also gave me a SQL question where I had to calculate the average ratings for a movie using two tables with joins. After that, there was a question on data warehousing concepts, which I wasn't familiar with and I straight away said I don't know it.

The interview wrapped up with a few questions about BlackRock as a company and why I was interested in working there.

3. Technical Interview II [16 Students][30-40 mins]

This round had one senior interviewer who handled all the questions. He began with a quick introduction and even asked me to recall who had taken my Round 1, which I honestly couldn't remember .

Next, he went through all the projects from my resume and asked about the tech stack used. Since the role was for Data Engineering and most of my projects were in ML/Data Science, he wanted to know why I still felt I was a good fit.

After that, he asked me how to store a polynomial and gave around 5–6 SQL queries verbally. I requested to share my screen and solve them on notepad, and he was fine with that.

He then moved on to questions about RAG (Retrieval Augmented Generation) and asked if I was comfortable with it. Towards the end, the questions shifted to my daily use of AI, and he wrapped up by asking a thought-provoking one: “Why hire people when AI can already generate code?”

Useful Tips:

- Practice DSA using Stiver's Sheet
- Dont miss out on Company Hackathons, one of the mistake I did. As they help a lot in hiring.
- Practice aptitude on IndiaBix
- Try to maintain a CGPA of 8+
- If possible try to remember who took your initial interview rounds,
- Also dont be demotivated by rejections, I also got rejected from few companies right in the final round. Luck plays an important role in the process.
- If it happens to you that interview is online and they give you a question without asking you to code, still share the screen and write logic on the notepad.